to deposit with the keeper (who sells liquors): he is allowed to call for a bottle of it a day, paying the keeper two stivers a bottle. The city allows each debtor one quart of beer daily, and turf for firing.

By conversing with the debtors, I found that they were all alimented alike, the first fourteen days at eleven stivers or a shilling a day; after that time at five stivers and a half. But this is paid to the gaoler, who has great profit out of it, as appeared from the daily allowance, which I weighed several times. Their two rooms are thoroughly cleaned and white-washed twice a year.

In this city they compute 250,000 souls, about one-third of those in London: yet in 1775, I found but eighteen debtors; in 1776, only fifteen; in 1778, eighteen; in June 1781 sixteen, and in November, seventeen; and in June 1783, seventeen.

The walls of this prison are stone twenty-two inches thick; most of the rooms ten feet by nine and a half; each for one prisoner only; a bedstead, etc. The doorway twenty-two inches wide; door three inches and a half thick, and plated with iron: the condemned rooms have an iron door besides. There are on the ground floor two rooms for debtors, and twelve or thirteen for criminals, which open into passages seven feet wide; and below ground there are eight rooms more for criminals. The windows are double barred, and open into a passage in which there is a strong door between every two cells. In the condemned rooms a criminal is never left alone: two prisoners from the rasp-house are always with him to prevent his destroying himself. They rejoice at the service; for if they discharge it faithfully, their reward is an abridgment of their allotted term. The execution is generally performed within forty-eight hours after sentence. From a book containing the names and crimes of all who have been executed at Amsterdam, from January 1693 to the end of 1766, the following state of executions at different periods is drawn.

From 1693 to 1735 (43 years) 288
1736 to 1745 (10 years) 20
1746 to 1766 (21 years) 28

And I have been well informed, that in the eight years preceding my visit in 1783, only five criminals were executed; two of them were beheaded, one broken on the wheel, and two hanged.

The instruments of torture are still in the magistrates' room, I hope only *in terrorem*, for the laws in general are not

sanguinary, and justice is executed, though with a steady, yet with a lenient hand.

The children of the malefactors who are executed, and of those who are committed for a long term, to the rasp- or spin-house, are sent to the orphan-house, and there brought up in industry, and not left destitute vagabonds to become unhappy victims to the wickedness and folly of their parents.

At the rasp-house over the gate, there is in bas relief, a device of a man driving a wagon loaded with logwood, drawn by lions, wild boars, and tigers, with this inscription:

Virtutis est domare
Quæ cuncti pavent.

Over this device, there is a representation of two men in chains, with a woman near them, holding the arms of Amsterdam in her left hand, and a whip in her right, and over her head the word "Castigatio." At the inner gate is (as at other rasp-houses) a representation of two men rasping logwood: which is here their principal employment. Yet regard is had, not only to their degree of guilt, but to their strength: for I saw two men winding silk. In summer 1776 there were fifty-four prisoners. In some rooms, where they also sleep, there were ten or twelve men rasping an appointed task. Others were in the warehouses, sorting and weighing; others bringing the wood to those rooms. Hours of work from six to twelve, and from one to four. In extra hours they make tobacco-boxes, etc., which they sell to visitants, who pay two stivers to go in.

The four regents who manage the rasp-house are appointed by the burgomasters, to whom they are accountable.[1] The gaoler or father is strictly obliged to obey all the orders of the high-bailiff, the burgomasters, and also of the regents. In no case may he, or any of his family, receive a gift from the prisoners or their friends, either before or after their enlargement. He must not entrust a servant with the keys, but must himself carefully search the convicts and their cots, or rooms, before he locks them up in the evening; at six o'clock in summer, and at four in winter. The father must never be absent a night, without special permission. He is severely punished if any prisoner escapes. He must register in order all acts concerning commitments and discharges, and produce

[1] It may be proper to mention, that these regents have no salaries, but only some privileges and honorary distinctions; as exemption from the city watch; liberty of free entrance after one of the city gates is shut; and a deacon's seat in the church.